

OFFICE OF THE MAYOR

Lynn Stoner, Mayor

**PLANNING, ZONING &
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT**

Danny A. Holmes, AICP, Director



CITY COUNCIL

Nick Sortal, *President*
Denise Horland, *President Pro Tem*
Erik Anderson
Mark Hyatt
Ron Jacobs

**PLANTATION GATEWAY DEVELOPMENT DISTRICT
ADVISORY BOARD LUNCHEON MEETING**

**Development Services Building
First Floor Conference Room
401 NW 70th Terrace, Plantation, FL 33317**

**Thursday, February 13, 2020
12:00 PM - 1:30 PM**

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| 1) Call to Order | Chair, Mike Hooley |
| 2) Introductions | Mike Hooley |
| 3) Introduction of new Gateway Police Officers | Captain Doug Powell |
| 4) Approval of December 12, 2019 Minutes
<i>Requires Board Approval</i> | Mike Hooley |
| 5) Gateway Financial Report - December 2019 | Susan DiLaura |
| 6) Gateway Development Update | Susan DiLaura |
| 7) Gateway Policing Plan Update | Captain Doug Powell |
| 8) Adjournment | |

Note: Information on item 7 will be provided at the meeting.

Next Meeting: Thursday, April 9, 2020

Minutes of the Regular Meeting of the
Plantation Gateway Advisory Board
City of Plantation, Florida,
February 13, 2020

Members Present:

Kevin Bingham
Dean Bromante
Jeff Burley, Vice Chair
Natasha De Wet
Mike Hooley, Jr., Chair

Members Absent:

Kenneth Anson
Grant Einhorn

Also Present:

Peter Dokuchitz, Planner
Captain Douglas Powell, Police
Officer E. Romain
Officer C. Palmieri
Mayor Lynn Stoner
Jason Nunemaker, Chief Administrative Officer (CAO)
Dawn Mehler, Administrative Analyst
Councilmember Nick Sortal
Matthew Schnor, resident

The meeting was called to order by Mike Hooley, Jr., Chair.

Self-introductions were made.

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Introduction of new Gateway Police Officers

Captain Doug Powell introduced new Gateway Officers, Officer Romain and Officer Palmieri. Every year their department goes through a schedule change based upon their CDA, which is their contract, and Officers are able to sign up for different shifts. There have been conversations with Officer Romain and Officer Palmieri as well as with their other Patrol Captain regarding duties and responsibilities. Next week these Officers will attend a 40-hour class for homeless outreach, which will give them additional tools to deal with certain situations. The Officers will reach out to Board members to exchange phone numbers, so there is a direct link.

Chair Hooley, Jr. mentioned people on drugs, perhaps flakka, who barge into the showroom and are out of control.

Captain Powell stated that flakka is phased out, there are methamphetamines and some are mixed with fentanyl; the Fire Department has Narcan for those types of situations. Police Officers do not have Narcan because it needs to be stored at a certain temperature.

Chair Hooley, Jr. welcomed the new Officers.

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Minutes of the December 12, 2019 meeting were approved as presented.

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GATEWAY FINANCIAL REPORT – December 2019

Mr. Dokuchitz reported that the Fiscal Year end 2019 report was not available, but it could be discussed at the April meeting or emailed in advance. Anticipated ad valorem revenue for the 2019/2020 budget is approximately \$520,000 and as of December 31, 2019, 84%, or \$400,000 of the taxes, have been collected. It was noted that advertising was part of the Chamber Business Directory ad.

Mr. Burley requested the Fiscal Year end 2019 report be emailed upon availability.

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GATEWAY DEVELOPMENT UPDATE

Mr. Dokuchitz provided the following project updates:

- PIXL – Approval was received from City Council and they are waiting for permitting.
- 7-Eleven Mobil Gas Station – Waiting on their CO.
- 311 Residential – In permit review.
- Alexan – In permit review.
- Chase Bank – In permit review.
- Strata Townhomes – Under construction.
- Burger King – Under construction.
- Rick Case – Under construction.
- The Genesis Sales – Under construction.
- Wawa – In for inspections.

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GATEWAY POLICING PLAN UPDATE

Captain Powell reported that three more companies from the Gateway District were added to the Trespass Program and he mentioned “No Parking” signs on Bryan Boulevard. He met with Brett Butler, City Engineer, and different situations for that street were discussed. According to Planning and Zoning, the building is only 50% occupied and parking is already spilling over into the swale area, which is a City code violation. A few options were discussed and some would have a cost, such as the street being redesigned to include street parking on both sides; some trees would have to be removed.

In response to Ms. De Wet, Captain Powell stated there would be a cost, but he did not know who would pay; it would beautify the area.

Captain Powell advised the Police Department is planning a traffic initiative in February where there will be a saturation, which entails inviting law enforcement from all over the County. It is like a DUI checkpoint; they will take different streets based upon their accident analysis. He noted the saturation is for speed, bald tires, lights out, etc. Groups would be placed in different areas as needed.

Ms. De Wet mentioned drivers running red lights on Broward Boulevard and SW 46th Avenue, Fig Tree Lane, and East Acre Drive.

Chair Hooley, Jr. commented that the businesses would like to be included in any saturations. He questioned if the City has radar and also questioned the status of placing license plate readers at entry points.

Captain Powell stated there is one speed trailer; actually two, but one is newer and designed differently. It records the speed of cars and keeps the data; date, time, and speed. The trailer can be moved anywhere there is a problem and after a week the data would be analyzed to determine what percentage of cars were speeding. Information regarding license plate readers at entry points has been forwarded to Dawn Mehler in Administration.

Mayor Stoner indicated the information would be reviewed to make sure it was what is needed prior to presenting it to the Board.

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Mayor Stoner attended the U.S. Mayor's Conference in Washington, D.C. Most cities are looking at a more global views and many are still using the 2000 Census numbers, so there is a potential to lose a lot of money. Creative ways are being considered to do more grants and leverage bond money with surtax money.

Chair Hooley, Jr. questioned the status of the FP&L State Road 7 project taking down the lines.

Mayor Stoner advised they are getting ready to do the landscaping. FP&L has various projects, but Brett Butler, City Engineer, is monitoring the project at State Road 7 and Broward Boulevard.

Chair Hooley, Jr. requested Brett Butler, City Engineer, attend the next meeting to provide an update.

Councilmember Sortal met Principal Pitter of Plantation Elementary during a Park East Homeowner's Association meeting. Perhaps the businesses could partner or visit their campus and keep them in mind when trying to do outreach.

Chair Hooley, Jr. agreed. He would like to meet Principal Pitter and requested his contact information be shared.

Ms. De Wet commented that she has been in the process of trying to get her front sign approved and while doing so she has observed many signs that do not meet code. She questioned if a goal was to beautify the Gateway area.

Mayor Stoner advised beautification of the Gateway District is a goal, but rules are only good for people who live by them. She met with the Code Inspectors yesterday and a variety of things were discussed, one of which were the signs.

Ms. De Wet stated the signs she was talking about are existing and need signage; her sign is plexiglass.

Mayor Stoner questioned why the landlord was not taking care of her sign if there is an existing monument sign.

Ms. De Wet indicated she is in the process of purchasing the property, so she has taken that responsibility. She questioned if the process could be made easier so everyone has nice signs along State Road 7. Another eyesore mentioned was the huge "For Rent" signs.

Mayor Stoner stated that signs are only allowed to be a total of 16 square feet. She does not think there is enough Code Enforcement for 22 miles. They are trying to educate Code Inspectors and empower them as to what their true focus needs to be and signage is always at the top of every City's list. A lot of time is being spent following up; there are \$34 million to \$35 million in Code Enforcement liens. An RFP was recently put out to hire a collection agency and/or law firm to do collections; \$34 million will not be collected, but Mayor Stoner wants compliance.

In response to Ms. De Wet's question about pressure cleaning sidewalks, Mayor Stoner stated that to her knowledge, the upkeep of sidewalks does not belong to the City.

Mr. Bromante advised that residents and businesses maintain their sidewalks.

Mayor Stoner did not disagree in any way. The Façade Program was done and there were about five takers. Landscaping was reviewed and they are going to try to incorporate consistently through the corridor.

Chair Hooley, Jr. requested the Board be involved in the landscaping discussions.

Mayor Stoner mentioned the risk that comes with Royal Palms and she did not think that was how to welcome people to Plantation. They are trying to do a combination of Crepe Myrtles, maybe some Ligustrum, and one more Florida tree, and instead of having a row of a hedge, which will be Clusia, there would be a hedge, a tree, then a hedge, and a tree, so there are not two rows of planting. Planting must be done in threes; three of one color in one location and three of another color in a different location. Crepe Myrtles drop leaves for four or five months, so there needs to be green in that area, not just flowers that drop and that do not work well in car lots.

Chair Hooley, Jr. thought that topic should be included in this meeting, as business owners are very particular.

Mayor Stoner welcomed any suggestions. She noted that depending on where landscaping is planted, the sight line must be kept.

Chair Hooley, Jr. stated that was key for him; they do not want to cover businesses with Clusia hedges. This is a commercial street, not a residential community.

Mayor Stoner commented that perhaps they could do Green Island Ficus instead of Clusia.

Chair Hooley, Jr. thought that would be perfect; they are tight and low to the ground. He did not think new Royal Palms should be put in; however, the row of Royal Palms on the south end look great. He would be happy to be a part of the solution in figuring out things to better the Gateway District and stated that Mayor Stoner's attendance to these meetings is a game changer. He noted that Councilmember Sortal is the only Councilmember who attends this meeting and perhaps the other Councilmembers could be reminded to join. He suggested Department Heads attend these meetings as well, especially Landscaping, Code Enforcement, and Engineering; attendance is critically important.

Ms. De Wet questioned who she could contact about a patch of lawn that is all weeds; she wants to get rid of the weeds and have a decent lawn.

Mayor Stoner requested Ms. De Wet take a picture and send it to her and then said she would drive by. She noted that hearsay is great and delegating is good, but there is a certain component of knowing your own City.

Ms. De Wet announced their Grand Opening on Saturday, March 21, 2020.

Mayor Stoner indicated if Ms. De Wet sends an invite, she would put it on the City Facebook page. There are different ways to assist and that is one way.

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Meeting adjourned at 12:43 p.m.

RECORD ENTRY:

I HEREBY CERTIFY that the Original of the foregoing document was received by the office of the City Clerk and entered into the Public Record this _____ day of _____, 2020.

Susan Slattery, City Clerk